

Meeting Notes — Michael A. Campbell, Ed.D.

SignalVerified · intro & discovery call · prepared for Arslan Noor, CTO, ElectroCom IT

Call: Wednesday 2026-08-26 · 11:00 PM PKT / 11:00 AM PDT · 30 minutes · booked via his Calendly

Pipeline: row 1581 · P7 · Direct Client · day-0 accept, replied "happy to chat" within ~1 minute and sent his own Calendly

1. Who he is

- **Founder & CEO, SignalVerified** (San Diego). Also Founder & CEO of **Work Ready Partners**, the same thesis under an earlier brand.
- **Ed.D.** 20+ years at **Intel**, rising to **General Manager**. Then **GM at Lenovo Japan**. Global education and technology initiatives with full P&L across the US and Asia.
- **Not an engineer.** He is a P&L operator and an education-systems person. He will judge you on clarity, judgment and credibility, not on stack trivia. He has bought engineering before; he has never been the one building it.
- Public profile: Men To Watch Awards 2026, speaks on human agency in the age of AI (Penn AI).

Rapport read: Intel and Lenovo Japan means he ran global distributed teams and has managed offshore delivery for years. He will be comfortable with a Pakistan-based team *if* we show up as senior peers. He speaks in standards, governance and evidence. Match that register.

2. What SignalVerified actually is (know this cold)

One line: pre-offer hiring evidence. An employer sends the role and its finalists, SignalVerified puts them through a role-calibrated realistic work scenario, two independent human experts review the output against a published standard, and the employer gets "**TheSignal**", a one-page evidence report, within 72 hours.

His words, verbatim:

- "You make the hiring decision. We bring the evidence."
- "Not a test · Not a screener · Evidence from the work itself"
- "Finalists work realistic scenarios with AI allowed and disclosed."
- "Two humans review it. Independent experts. **No AI scoring.**"

Named frameworks: Work Ready Impact Framework (Relevance, Mastery, Communication, Collaboration) · the SignalVerified Standard (published rubric) · TheSignal (the report).

Roles covered: early-career knowledge work. Data, business, product, marketing, revenue and operations analysts.

Two-sided model: employers pay, schools partner. UC San Diego is the launch university. Student side runs as "Get Verified" cohorts, currently **Cohort 2**.

Published pricing:

Tier	Price
One hiring decision (up to 3 finalists, +\$999 each additional)	\$2,999
Signal Review, single finalist	\$2,999
Calibration session (credited toward a decision within 30 days)	\$299/hr
Evidence-Based Hiring Program (reusable role configs, governance, reporting)	from \$24,000/yr
Enterprise (multiple teams, integrations, SLA, enterprise governance)	custom

Guarantee: *"If TheSignal does not influence your hiring decision, you do not pay."*

Stage: bootstrapped and self-funded. NVIDIA Inception member. Effectively a 1–2 person build. Founding-partner employers being recruited right now.

3. The one insight to walk in with

His moat and his bottleneck are the same thing: two independent human reviewers plus adjudication, on every single submission, inside 72 hours.

That is what makes TheSignal credible, and it is also what stops him getting from a handful of pilot employers to the \$24k/yr program tier and enterprise. At \$2,999 a decision, every hour of reviewer recruiting, calibration, disagreement resolution and report writing comes straight out of margin, and none of it compounds unless there is real tooling underneath it.

So what we sell is not "add AI to your scoring." It is: build the system that makes human review fast, consistent, auditable and repeatable, so the standard survives volume.

Say it roughly like this, once, and only after he has described the problem in his own words:

"The thing that makes TheSignal credible is the part that's hardest to scale. Most people in your position eventually try to fix that by letting a model do the scoring, and that's exactly what would break the product. The other route is to build the tooling around the humans, so each review takes half the time and consistency becomes something you can actually measure. That second one is what my team does."

Hard rule for this call

Do not propose AI scoring of candidate work. It contradicts his published standard, his ethics page and his entire differentiation. AI is welcome anywhere that is *not* the judgment: scenario generation, reviewer prep, draft summarization, evidence extraction, anomaly and plagiarism flags, ops.

4. Objective

It is a 30-minute intro. The goal is not a proposal. The goal is:

1. Find out where the build is actually stuck and what he must ship in the next 90 days.
2. Leave one credible proof point (OpenAI video-model work).
3. Book a second, longer, technical conversation. Ideally a small paid one.

Success looks like: he says "let's get into the details," and you leave with a date.

5. How to open (first 90 seconds)

Peer level, no pitch:

"Thanks for moving so fast on this, I appreciate it. I've read the site and the pricing so I have the shape of it. Before I say anything about us, I'd rather hear it from you. What made you leave the GM track to go build this?"

Then stop talking. He has a thesis and he is good at telling it. Let him run for five minutes.

Two lines that buy credibility early. Drop them naturally, not back to back:

- "The 'AI allowed and disclosed' choice is the right call. Most assessment products are still pretending candidates aren't using it."
- "The refund promise tells me you're selling a decision, not a score."

6. Questions to ask

Pick from these, don't recite them. Block B is the one that matters most.

A. Business and stage

1. Where are you today, how many employers have actually run a Signal versus are in conversation?
2. Is UC San Diego live, or still being stood up? What did that take?
3. Are you self-funding through the pilots, or raising once you have proof?
4. What has to be true by the end of this year for you to call it working?

B. The bottleneck (spend the most time here)

5. Walk me through what actually happens from "employer sends finalists" to "report delivered." Where do the 72 hours go?
6. Who are the two reviewers? Contractors, a standing network, or you personally?
7. What happens when the two disagree? How is that adjudicated today?
8. How do you keep two different reviewers scoring the same submission the same way? Is inter-rater agreement something you can measure right now, or is it still a judgment call?
9. How much of that runs on the platform, and how much is you in spreadsheets and email?
10. If ten employers signed this month, what breaks first?

C. Product and technical

11. What exists on the platform today? Candidate portal, reviewer workspace, report generation? What's solid and what's held together?
12. Who builds it? You, a contractor, an agency?
13. Where is AI in the stack today, and where is the line you've decided not to cross?
14. The program tier promises reusable role configurations, governance and reporting. How far is that from what's actually built?
15. Enterprise mentions integrations and SLAs. Which ATS do buyers keep asking about, Greenhouse, Lever, Workday?

D. Commercial pull-through (his real risk)

L6. On the school side, what stops a cohort from turning into a paying employer contract?

L7. What's the objection you hear most from employers, and does it change once they see a sample Signal?

E. The opening

L8. If two senior engineers started Monday, what would you point them at first?

L9. What's on the roadmap that you've already decided you can't build this year?

7. What to say about us

Only after a real gap has surfaced. 60 to 90 seconds, maximum.

- "I'm a senior AI engineer, eight years in. Last year I worked with OpenAI on training their video generation models. I run a team of eleven across AI/ML, full-stack, DevOps and data engineering."
- "The work I like is exactly your shape. A domain expert with a real standard and no engineering org underneath it."
- One capability line tied to *his* problem, not a service menu: "Reviewer tooling, evidence pipelines, audit trails, ATS integrations, and the reporting layer enterprise buyers ask for."
- Engagement shapes, if he asks: a scoped build with fixed price and fixed output, or senior engineers embedded on his roadmap.

Do not say

"US-registered company with an offshore team," "cost-effective," "world-class," "end-to-end solutions." He ran offshore delivery at Intel and Lenovo. Cheap framing moves you into vendor management, which is exactly where we don't want to be.

8. Objections to have ready

He says	You say
"I'm bootstrapped, I can't afford a dev team."	Agree, and don't sell an engagement. Offer one small paid piece with a defined output, such as a two-week architecture and reviewer-workflow spike at a fixed price. If it doesn't pay for itself in reviewer hours, we stop there.
"The human review IS the product. I'm not automating it."	Agree first, out loud. We are not touching the judgment. We remove everything around the judgment that isn't judgment.
"I already have a developer / an agency."	Fine. Ask what they own and where the gaps are. Position alongside them: integrations, data and AI layer, DevOps, enterprise readiness. Don't try to displace.
"Why work with a team overseas?"	Use his own history. He ran global teams at Intel and Lenovo Japan, so he knows the model works when the seniority is real. Then offer a small paid piece so the decision rests on evidence rather than a pitch. That framing is literally his own thesis, and it will land.
"Send me a proposal."	A trap this early. "Give me 45 minutes to look at the actual workflow first. Then what I send you will be worth reading."

9. What to ask for at the end

Primary ask: "Can we book 45 minutes where you walk me through the reviewer workflow end to end? I'll come back with where the time is going and what I'd build first. No charge for that."

If he's hot: propose the paid two-week spike. Fixed price, defined deliverable, clear stop point.

If he's lukewarm: ask for a redacted sample Signal Summary, and offer to send one specific useful thing. Not a deck.

Always close on a date. "Does the same time next week work?"

10. Watch-outs

- **Budget is genuinely thin.** Bootstrapped, pre-scale, single-digit employers. Right-size the first ask or you get a polite no.
- **He may want a technical co-founder or an equity CTO,** not a paid vendor. If that surfaces, don't say no in the room and don't say yes. "Let's talk about the shape of it once I've seen the workflow."
- **Strong narrative, unknown product maturity.** He is a polished communicator with a well-built story. Questions 5, 9, 11 and 12 are the ones that tell you what is actually built.
- **Two brands in play** (Work Ready Partners and SignalVerified). Ask which entity is the one going forward rather than guessing.

11. Immediately after the call

- Log the outcome in `reports/2026-08-26.md`.
- Update sheet row 1581: status, next action, next action date.
- Send a short recap within two hours: one line on what you heard, one concrete observation, the agreed next step and its date. No attachment.

Sources: signalverified.net (home, pricing, about, signal-based-hiring), workreadypartners.com, LinkedIn, San Diego Business Journal, ElectroCom pipeline row 1581. Prepared 2026-08-26.